The University of Texas at Austin
UT High School

090319

English/Language Arts Grade 3 Study Guide
Credit by Exam for Acceleration

The exam you are interested in taking is designed to test your proficiency in the relevant subject matter. You should be thoroughly familiar with the subject matter before you attempt to take the exam. This CBE Study Guide can help you prepare for the exam by giving you an idea of what you need to review. You can check your familiarity level by reviewing the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS) for this course. (See below.) To refine your skills, you can refer to any of the state-adopted textbooks.

Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS)

Every question that appears on this exam is derived from the knowledge and skills statements and student expectations within the Texas-mandated standards, the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills (TEKS). You can view the TEKS for this exam online via the following link: http://ritter.tea.state.tx.us/rules/tac/chapter110/ch110a.html#110.5. Refer to section (b), Knowledge and skills, 1-12. Throughout this guide, you'll see TEKS references. These refer to the numbers listed under (b) Knowledge and skills; for example, 1A or 3B.

Materials Needed

You will need a #2 pencil for the print version of the exam.

Exam Structure

You will be allowed **3 hours** to complete this exam. English/Language Arts Grade 3 exam consists of 50 multiple-choice questions for a total of 100 points. The exam covers a wide variety of topics. To help you study, we have isolated 4 key topics and provided study tips and sample questions for each.

- **Speaking and Listening**
- **Reading Skills, Decoding, and Spelling**
- **Reading Comprehension and Response to Literature**
- **Writing, Revising, and Research**

Scholastic Honesty

When you arrive at the testing center you will be asked to carefully read the exam rules and sign a statement agreeing to take the exam in accordance with the rules. This is called the Examinee's Certification. The following is a copy of these rules:

Examinee's Certification

This certification must be signed *before* the exam is administered and then returned with the completed examination attached, or credit for the exam will not be given.

Scholastic dishonesty is a serious academic violation that will not be tolerated. Scholastic dishonesty encompasses, but is not limited to:

- copying from another student's work;
- using an unauthorized testing proctor or taking the exam at an unauthorized testing location;
- using materials not authorized by a testing proctor;
- possessing materials that are not authorized by a testing proctor, such as lessons, books, or notes;
- knowingly using or soliciting, in whole or Topic, the contents of an unadministered test;
- collaborating with or seeking aid from another student without authorization during the test;
- substituting for another person, or permitting another person to substitute for oneself, in taking a course test or completing any course-related assignment;
- using, buying, stealing, or transporting some or all of the contents of an unadministered test, test rubric, homework answer, or computer program.

Evidence of scholastic dishonesty will result in a grade of *F* on the examination and an *F* in the course (if applicable).

At the testing center, you will be asked to sign a statement that says you have read the above and agree to complete the examination with scholastic honesty.

General Study Tips

The bulleted lists and sample questions in this study guide can assist you in preparing for the exam. It is a fairly complete guide for studying, but does not cover every item on the test. Ultimately, you should use the TEKS to guide your exam preparation.

Additional Study Tips

The following information provides direction for your studies. For each part, you will find study tips and sample questions to give you a general idea of the types of questions you can expect to see on the exam.

Part 1: Speaking and Listening

This section of the exam relates to TEKS in section 1. Familiarize yourself with those TEKS, and then be prepared to demonstrate knowledge of the following topics:

- Listening actively asking questions and making comments
- Following, restating, and giving instructions that involve a series of actions
- Speak coherently about a topic using good speaking technique
- Developing social communication

Sample Questions for Part 1:

The following are sample questions. You can find the correct answers listed after the questions, but try answering the questions without looking at the answers first.

1. Trinidad's mother asks him to clean his room immediately. Which response is the most polite?

   A. "I will do that now, Mother."
   B. "Can't you see that I am busy?"
   C. "Tomorrow, I will do it."
   D. "I don't want to. Do I have to?"

Part 2: Reading Skills

This section of the exam relates to TEKS 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6. Familiarize yourself with those TEKS, and then, be prepared to demonstrate knowledge of the following topics:

- Using phonological awareness, print concepts, phonics, and morphology to develop and maintain language skills
- Understanding open/closed syllables, VCe syllable, vowel teams including digraphs and diphthongs, r-controlled syllable, final stable syllables, syllable division patterns such as VCCV VCV, and VCCCV
- Determining the meaning of words through context as well as roots and affixes
- Adjusting fluency when reading grade-level text
- Reading independently self-selected texts
- Using metacognitive skills to enhance comprehension such as establishing a purpose for reading, generating questions while reading, creating visual images while reading,

making predictions, making connections, making inferences, evaluating details, synthesizing information, and monitoring comprehension and making adjustments while reading.

Sample Questions for Part 2:
The following are sample questions. You can find the correct answers listed after the questions, but try answering the questions without looking at the answers first.

2. When the prefix *re* is added to the word *count* how does the meaning change?

   A. Re means before. Recount means to count something before counting something else.
   B. Re means not. Recount means to not count something.
   C. Re means again. Recount means to count again.
   D. Re means wrong or wrongly. Recount means to count incorrectly.

3. Which of the following lists of words is in the correct alphabetical order?

   A. passage, paper, paste, pasta
   B. animal, anteater, antimatter, asteroid
   C. elephant, elementary, electricity, elated
   D. mirth, mistake, miser, mirror

4. Leon sees the word "mistaken" in a story he is reading and wants to break it apart to make it easier to read. What would be the best way to break apart the word "mistaken?"

   A. mi-st-ak-en
   B. mist-ak-e-n
   C. m-ist-aken
   D. mis-tak-en

5. Which of the following is the correct way to write "I love to eat hamburgers" in cursive?

   A. *I love to eat hamburgers.*
   B. *Ilove to eat hamburgers.*
   C. *I love to eat h amburgers.*
   D. *I loveto eat hamburgers.*

Part 3: Reading Comprehension and Response to Literature

This section of the exam relates to TEKS 7, 8, 9, and 10. Familiarize yourself with those TEKS, and then, be prepared to demonstrate knowledge of the following topics:

- Writing responses that demonstrate understanding of texts
- Using texts to support a response
- Retelling, paraphrasing, and summarizing texts
- Inferring themes
- Analyzing character motivations, plots features, and setting
- Demonstrating knowledge of various literary genres (folktales, fables, fairy tales, legends, myths, poetry, fiction, drama, informational and persuasive texts and the characteristics of each genre
- Analyzing a central idea, organizational patterns, text features and use of facts in arguments
- Analyzing author's purpose, message, text structure, use of figurative language, use of language
- Explaining the use of hyperbole

Sample Questions for Topic 3:
The following are sample questions. The correct answers are at the end of this study guide, but try answering the questions without looking at the answers first to check your comprehension.

DIRECTIONS: Select the BEST responses to the following questions.

Emma's Picture
By Debra L. Cole
Illustrated by Stephanie Roth

Emma walked down the stairs with a big piece of clean, white paper.

"I'm going to draw an eagle," she said to herself. "I'll draw an eagle with wide brown wings and great big claws. I'll draw a tree beside him."

Carefully, she laid her paper on the table. She took her box of crayons from the drawer. She picked out a long, brown crayon with a pointed tip. She drew a small. brown spot.

"Emma, I'm going to the store," said her mother. "I need to write my shopping list, and I can't find a piece of paper. Have you seen any?"

Emma thought for a moment. "I can give you half of my piece," she said.
She folded the paper and carefully tore it down the middle. She handed half to her mother.

"Thank you very much, dear," said her mother. "I can write my list now."

"You're welcome," said Emma.

She took her half of the paper and looked at the small brown spot. The paper was too small to draw an eagle.

"I can draw a robin," she thought. "I'll draw a robin with a bright orange chest and yellow claws. I'll draw a nest beside him."

Emma took a short orange crayon from her box. The crayon had no wrapper on it, and it felt smooth to her fingers. She made a small orange spot next to the small brown spot.

"Emma, Grandma is on the phone," called her father. "I need to write a message. Do you know where I can find some paper?"

Emma looked at her piece of paper with the long torn edge. "You can have half of mine, Dad," she said.

She folded the paper carefully and tore it down the middle. She handed half to her father.

"Thank you very much," he said. "Now I won't forget to take Grandma to the garage to get her car."

"You're welcome, Dad," said Emma.

She looked at her paper. She looked at the small brown spot and the small orange spot. She looked at the two torn edges. The paper was too small to draw a robin. "What can I draw now?" thought Emma. She liked to figure out things.

She got an idea. She took a black crayon out of the box. She drew long, curvy lines. Then she took a bright yellow crayon out of the box. She filled in all the black lines with the yellow crayon, being very careful to go around the small orange spot and the small brown spot. Then she was finished.

There," she thought. "I think that's very pretty."

She looked at her piece of paper. She looked at the torn edges. She looked at the curvy black lines and the bright yellow spaces inside.

She looked at the brown spot on one side and the orange spot on the other.
It wasn't an eagle. It wasn't a robin. But it was a beautiful butterfly.

6. What sentence from the story lets the reader know that Emma was pleased with her drawing?

A. "She liked to figure out things."
B. "You're welcome," said Emma.
C. "But it was a beautiful butterfly."
D. "Then she was finished."

7. Complete the cause and effect.

Cause	Effect
Emma had to give away most of her drawing paper.	

A. Emma will have more than one sheet of paper the next time she draws a picture.
B. Emma will give all her paper away to her family.
C. Emma will have to be creative with the paper she has.
D. Emma will use markers next time she draws a picture.

8. Read these lines from the story.

Then she took a bright yellow crayon out of the box. She filled in all the black lines with the yellow crayon, being very careful to go around the small orange spot and the small brown spot.

What is the most likely reason the author included these lines?

A. to help the reader understand what Emma was feeling.
B. to persuade the reader to draw his or her own picture.
C. to help the reader picture what Emma's drawing looked like.
D. to show the reader that Emma's drawing was pretty.

Part 4: Writing, Revising, and Research

This section of the exam relates to TEKS 11, 12, and 13. Familiarize yourself with those TEKS, and then be prepared to demonstrate knowledge of the following topics:

- Understanding the writing process including writing the first draft, revising, editing, and publishing
- Understanding the importance of purpose, organizational structure, engaging idea, and use of grammatical conventions
- Understanding the functions of various writing genres (literary, personal narrative, informational, persuasive, correspondence) as platforms for a written message

- Understanding of the importance of the research question, research plan, relevant sources (both primary and secondary), a bibliography, and avoidance of plagiarism when conducting inquiry and research

Sample Questions for Part 4:
The following are sample questions. You can find the correct answers listed after the questions, but try answering the questions without looking at the answers first to check your comprehension.

DIRECTIONS: Select the BEST responses to the following questions.

Benjamin Franklin

(1) America has never forgotten Benjamin Franklin. He became famous for being a scientist, an inventor, a statesman, and many other things. Today, we honor Ben Franklin as one of our Founding Fathers, and as one of America's greatest citizens.
(2) Ben is the only person to have signed all four of the documents which helped to create the United States, including the Declaration of Independence (1776) and the Constitution (1787). He actually helped to write parts of them. No other person was more involved in the birth of our nation.
(3) Besides helping to mold the United States of America, Ben helped to make everyday life in the city better. He served as Postmaster, helping to set up the postal system in Philadelphia. In order to make Philadelphia a safer city, he started the Union Fire Company in 1736. A few years later, in 1752, he set up America's first fire insurance company. Ben also had the idea for Daylight Savings Time.
(4) In the 1700s, a scientist was someone who thought about the way things work, and tried to figure out ways to make things work better. Today, that is still true. Every time Ben Franklin saw a question and tried to answer it, he was a scientist. Every time you ask a question and try to get an answer, you, too, are a scientist. Ben is most famous for his questions about electricity, but he also experimented with many other ideas in nature.
(5) Everyone knows the story of Ben's famous kite flight. Although he did a lot of experiments with electricity, Ben did not "invent" electricity. He did, however, invent the lightning rod, which protected buildings and ships from lightning damage.
(6) A list of Benjamin Franklin's inventions <u>reveals</u> a man of many talents and interests. It was the scientist in Ben that brought out the inventor. His natural curiosity about things and the way they work made him try to find ways to make them work better.
(7) Ben had poor <u>vision</u> and needed glasses to read. He got tired of always taking them off, and putting them back on, so he decided to figure out a way to make his glasses let him see both near and far. He had two pairs of spectacles

(glasses) cut in half. He put half of each lens in a single frame. Today, we call them bifocals.
(8) Ben Franklin died at the age of 84 on April 17, 1790. Even though he lived over 200 years ago, he still did many wonderful things for our country and our world today.

9. Eliza took notes to write her essay. She created a graphic organizer to help her organize her information. What information should go in the empty box?

Topic	Benjamin Franklin
Topic sentence	
Three supporting facts or details	1) He set up the postal system in Philadelphia. 2) He invented the lightning rod. 3) He invented bifocal glasses.
Concluding statement	Even though he lived over 200 years ago, he still did many wonderful things for our country and our world today.

A. He became famous for being a scientist, an inventor, a statesman, and many other things.
B. America has never forgotten Benjamin Franklin.
C. Ben Franklin died at the age of 84 on April 17, 1790.
D. No other person was more involved in the birth of our nation.

10. Eliza wants to make a research plan and gather information from multiple sources, including an expert source. Which of these could be some steps from her plan?

A.

Step 1: Look up Benjamin Franklin in the encyclopedia
Step 2: Research my topic online
Step 3: Interview someone from the history museum

B.

Step 1: Find Philadelphia on a map
Step 2: Research my topic online
Step 3: Interview my best friend

C.

Step 1: Look up Benjamin Franklin in the encyclopedia
Step 2: Visit a local science museum
Step 3: Interview someone from the history museum

D.

Step 1: Find Philadelphia on a map
Step 2: Research my topic online
Step 3: Interview my best friend

DIRECTIONS: Select the BEST responses to the following questions.

Juan's Surprise

(1) Juan woke up early one morning in May. (2) The flowers were blooming in his backyard and the birds were singing. (3) It was a beautiful day.

(4)"Saturday is Mom's birthday," Juan thought. (5) "How can I do something for her that she will appreciate?"

(6) Juan thought and thought. (7) "Maybe, I can buy her a new necklace or some other jewelry. (8) No, there is no way I can get to the store. (9) And, besides, I don't have enough money to buy something that Mom would really like."

(10) "What about cleaning out the garage. (11) Mom is always saying how messy it is. (12) No, I don't know what she wants to throw away or keep."

(13) "I know! (14) I'll cook supper for the family on Saturday night," Juan thought excitedly.

(15) Juan went into the kitchen to check Mom's recipes. (16) Juan and Mom did not always like the same food. (17) He found a recipe he knew Mom would like. (18) It was for Stroganoff Stew. (19) First, he read the list of ingredients. (20) He checked the pantry and freezer to see if they had everything he needed. (21) Yes, everything was there. (22) He still had two problems to fix before everything was settled.

(23) So, Juan asked his older sister, Silvia, if she would help him. (24) She said that his idea was a wonderful plan. (25) And she would be happy to help, especially since she didn't have a present for Mom either. (26) Juan also asked Dad if he would take Mom to the movie while he and Silvia cooked, so his idea could be a surprise. (27) Since they both agreed, he was all set.

(28) Juan and Sylvia prepared the supper of stew bread, and salad. (29) Mom was pleasantly surprised. (30) She even asked for a second helping!

11. The rubric provided by Ruben's teacher stated that students should use correct punctuation. The BEST revision Ruben could make is —

A. change ***Juan's Surprise*** to ***Juans Surprise*** in the title.
B. add a comma after ***stew*** in sentence 28.
C. change ***I'll*** to ***Ill*** in sentence 14.
D. remove the comma after ***First*** in sentence 19.

12. The BEST revision Ruben could make in sentences 24 and 25 is —

A. She said that his idea was a wonderful plan, and she would be happy to help, especially since she didn't have a present for Mom either.
B. She said that his idea was a wonderful plan. And she would be happy to help. Especially since she didn't have a present for Mom either.
C. She said that his idea was a wonderful plan and she would be happy to help especially since she didn't have a present for Mom either.
D. She said that his idea was a wonderful plan. And she would be happy to help, because especially since she didn't have a present for Mom either.

Answer Key

Item Number	Correct Answer	TEKS expectation
1	A	1E
2	C	2Av, 3C
3	B	2C
4	D	2Bvi, 3A
5	A	2D
6	C	7C, 8B
7	C	6Ai, 9Diii
8	C	7C, 8B
9	A	11A, 11Bi
10	A	13B
11	B	11Dx
12	A	11Di